

# User Guide: Input Provider

This guide explains how to use the platform as an **Input Provider**: managing your product catalogue (inputs), orders from farmers, inventory, and customers.

## 1. Logging in

- 1. Open the platform in your browser and go to **Login**.
- 2. Enter your **phone** (or email) and **password**.
- 3. Click **Sign in**. You are taken to **My Dashboard** (input provider); the sidebar shows the input-provider menu.

## 2. Main menu and navigation

After login, the sidebar shows:

| Menu item    | Path / Purpose                         |
|--------------|----------------------------------------|
| My Dashboard | Overview of your sales and orders      |
| My Inputs    | Manage your input products (catalogue) |
| Orders       | View and manage orders from farmers    |
| Inventory    | Manage stock levels for your inputs    |
| Customers    | View farmers who have ordered from you |

Use the **menu icon** on small screens to open or close the sidebar.

### 3. My Inputs (product catalogue)

**Essence:** **My Inputs** is your **product catalogue**—the list of seeds, fertiliser, or other inputs you offer. What you add here appears on the **Inputs marketplace** for farmers to browse and order, so your catalogue drives your sales on the platform.

**Flow:** Create input product → Set price and details → Farmers see it on the Inputs marketplace and order.

1. Go to **My Inputs** in the sidebar (or **Input Management** / **Input Inventory** depending on the label).
2. You see your **list of input products** (e.g. seeds, fertiliser, tools). Each may show name, category, unit, price, and stock level.
3. **Add a new input:** click **Add product** (or **New input**). In the form, enter:
  - **Name** (e.g. “OFSP vines – Kenya variety”)
  - **Category** (e.g. seeds, fertiliser, tools) if the form has it
  - **Unit** (e.g. kg, pack, litre)
  - **Price** (per unit)
  - **Description** (short text for farmers)
  - Optional: **image**, **stock quantity** (or set stock in **Inventory** later)
4. Save. The input **appears on the Inputs marketplace** for farmers to browse and order. You can **edit** (name, price, description) or **deactivate** (hide from marketplace) later from the same list.
5. Keep your catalogue up to date so farmers see accurate products and prices; update **Inventory** when you receive stock or fulfil orders.

### 4. Orders (from farmers)

**Essence:** **Orders** is where you **see and fulfil** every order farmers place on your inputs. Confirm, update status (e.g. Shipped, Delivered), and add notes so farmers can track their orders—so you close the loop from catalogue to delivery.

**Flow:** Farmer places order on marketplace → Order appears in your Orders → Confirm → Update status (e.g. Shipped, Delivered).

1. Go to **Orders** in the sidebar (or **Input Orders**).
2. You see **orders** placed by farmers in a list or table. Each may show order number, customer (farmer), items, quantity, total, date, and **status** (e.g. Pending, Confirmed, Processing, Shipped, Delivered).

3. Use **status filter** (e.g. Pending, Delivered) and **search** (customer name, order number) if available to find orders.
4. Click an order to open it. You see **customer** (farmer) name and contact, **items** (product, quantity, price), **total**, and **delivery/collection** details (e.g. address or collection point).
5. **Confirm** the order: if the status is Pending, click **Confirm** (or equivalent) to accept it. Optionally add **notes** (e.g. expected dispatch date).
6. **Update status** as you fulfil: e.g. **Processing** (preparing), **Shipped** (dispatched—add tracking if you have it), **Delivered** (farmer has received). Farmers may see these updates in their input orders view.
7. If you need to **cancel** or **reject** an order, use the option in the order details if available; inform the farmer if needed.

## 5. Inventory

**Essence:** **Inventory** is where you **manage stock levels** for each input. Update quantities when you receive stock or fulfil orders so farmers don't order out-of-stock items and you can plan restocking.

**Flow:** **Open Inventory** → **See list of products and quantities** → **Update quantities when you receive stock or fulfil orders**.

1. Go to **Inventory** in the sidebar (or **Input Inventory**—may be the same as **My Inputs** with stock levels shown).
2. You see your **products** with **current stock quantity** per item. The list may also show low-stock warnings or “out of stock” labels.
3. **Update stock:** open a product or use an “Edit quantity” or “Adjust stock” action. Set the new **quantity** (e.g. after receiving stock from your supplier or after fulfilling orders). Save.
4. When stock is **low** or **zero**, consider pausing sales for that product (e.g. deactivate in **My Inputs**) or restocking and updating **Inventory** again. This helps avoid orders you cannot fulfil.

## 6. Customers

**Essence:** **Customers** is your **list of farmers** who have ordered from you, with profile and order history. Use it for follow-up, support, and understanding who your buyers are.

**Flow:** **Open Customers** → **See list of farmers** → **Open customer for profile and order history**.

1. Go to **Customers** in the sidebar.
2. You see **farmers** who have placed at least one order with you. The list may show name, phone, location, number of orders, last order date.
3. Use **search** (name, phone) if available to find a customer.
4. Click a customer to view **profile** (name, contact, location) and **order history** (list of past orders, items, totals, status). Use this for **follow-up** (e.g. repeat orders, support) and to understand demand.

## 7. Notifications and profile

- **Notifications** (bell icon or in-app) may alert you to **new orders**. Open them to go to **Orders** and confirm or fulfil.
- Use **Settings** or **Profile** (if available) to update your business details or password.

## 8. Quick reference: key flows

| Goal           | Steps                                                                                            |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sell an input  | My Inputs → Add product (name, price, unit, description) → Save → Farmers order from marketplace |
| Handle order   | Orders → Open order → Confirm → Update status (Processing, Shipped, Delivered) and add notes     |
| Manage stock   | Inventory (or My Inputs) → Update quantity per product when you receive stock or fulfil orders   |
| See who bought | Customers → View list → Open customer for profile and order history                              |

For **farmers** ordering inputs, see [User Guide: Farmer](#) (section 7. Inputs).